

This anti-virus has a unique feature known as VRDB or the “Virus Recovery Database”. What the VRDB does is, it creates an integrity database of essential files on your computer; that is, it stores information about the state of the files, creating as many as three versions for each file. The VRDB is created either when the computer is idle or upon request. Through the VRDB, if a file is infected, it can be quickly restored to any of these three versions!

avast! 4.7 Home supports e-mail scanning for clients supporting SMTP, IMAP and POP3 such as MS Outlook, MS Exchange, Outlook Express, Eudora, Pegasus Mail, Netscape Mail, Mozilla Mail, and Incredimail. It can clean many adware and spyware, and can be updated automatically. It is also not too heavy on system resources.

We must state here that it increased the bootup time of our test machine by 12 seconds, which cannot be considered too little. The outbreak response time is between 8 and 10 hours—a mediocre showing. A complete scheduled scan is not supported, and you cannot selectively scan only executable files if you wish to.

Web site: www.avast.com

Minimum System Requirements: Windows 9x/ME/NT/2000/XP/x64 (not Server), 64 MB RAM for Windows 2000/XP, 50 MB of hard disk space, IE 4

3.2.2.3 AVG Anti-virus Free Edition

The AVG Anti-virus Free Edition is free for private, non-commercial, single home computer use. After installing the anti-virus checks for updates for virus definitions and prompts you to create rescue diskettes. A rescue disk can be the lifeline of your computer if it gets infected by a virus and refuses to boot. You can either make use of standard 1.44 MB floppy disks or simply save the recovery data to the hard drive and later burn it to a CD.

The interface of the AVG Control Center is not well-designed. Especially when other anti-virus solutions have put in so much